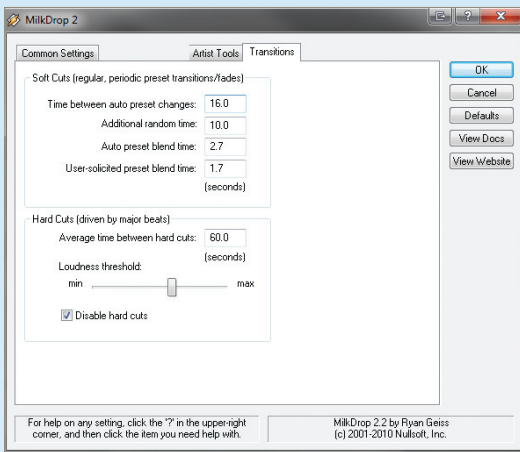




How to change the transitions in MilkDrop

pointed. Everything in an effect list gets rendered into a separate buffer before being added to its parent buffer. Because of this very fact, you have the power to create completely separate effects off screen, manipulate them freely, possibly blending them together, all before finally displaying the final effect in one shot.

To demonstrate this feature, we will create a new preset and add an Effect List in the similar fashion that we used in the previous example. Check the **Enabled** and **Clear every frame** check boxes in the right frame of the Effect list and select **Ignore** for the Input blend mode and **Subtractive Blend** for the Output blend mode. Next add a **Mosaic Trans** module and a **Simple Render** module. After this, exit the Effect List menu and go back to main. Here, add a **Fadeout Trans** module and set it to **Fade** to **Color**

Box with a colour of your choice. Also select the **Bass Spin** in the Main Render module.

This will give you a dark coloured Simple effect overlaid over the white Bass Spins because AVS will place the Bass Spin on the main preset buffer and the Effect list on a secondary buffer. This buffer starts out black (cleared every frame), ignores what is in its parent buffer and a Simple waveform is drawn into it. Now that all effects in the Effect List have been processed, the secondary buffer is blended back into the parent buffer using the blend mode **Subtractive Blend 1**. What this means is that you can prevent Trans modifiers from affecting whole groups of modules, which in turn gives you much finer control over the visual effects. You can keep trying other things in AVS and we're sure you will come up with very interesting visualisations.

What is MilkDrop?

MilkDrop is yet another music visualiser plugin for the Winamp music player. As you listen your music in Winamp, it creates spectacular visualisations that take the actual music you're hearing, and uses beat detection to trigger myriad psychedelic effects and create a rich visual journey through sound. The best part about this is that it takes the full power of modern graphics chips and programmable pixel shaders to the realm of music visualisation. Hundreds of complex instructions can be executed for every pixel on the screen, every frame to create the effect that you will cherish.

Like AVS, it is also a fully configurable platform that comes in-built with Winamp and allows you to design and create your own MilkDrop visual presets, which for MilkDrop is a collection of parameters that tell MilkDrop how to draw the wave, how to warp the image around,

and so on. Each preset is saved as a file with a .milk extension and you can use MilkDrop's in-built "preset-editing menu" (the [M] key), to edit presets on the fly, on-screen, from within the program. You can make slight adjustments to existing presets, or even write insane new mathematical equations, of your own imagination, into your preset files and come up with things that MilkDrop has never done before.

To edit the properties of the current preset, press [M] while using MilkDrop. It will bring up the Preset Editing Menu. From here, you can either change the existing presets or write your own .Milk file to make your own preset. To check out how to write .Milk files, go to http://dev.winamp.com/wiki/MilkDrop_Unleashed_Guide.

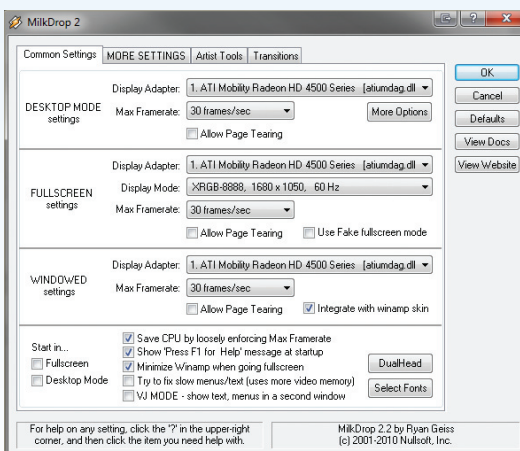


How to edit a .Milk file along with a sample .milk file

It'll give you a fair idea as to how you will need advanced mathematics with the knowledge of MilkDrop variables to create fascinating presets. Every line of a .Milk file is a variable and the value associated with it. You can find a sample preset for the butterfly effect at www.thinkdigit.com/d/butterfly.

Advanced Stuff

You can even write your own Winamp Visualizations plugin if AVS and MilkDrop doesn't provide you with all the transitions that you intend to have in your visualisation. You'll need the Winamp plugin SDK at www.winamp.com/nsdn/winamp2x/dev/plugins to get it to work with Winamp. We'll instead leave this to your creativity and programming skills. Send us your creations. **d**



MilkDrop 2 Settings